

Masking

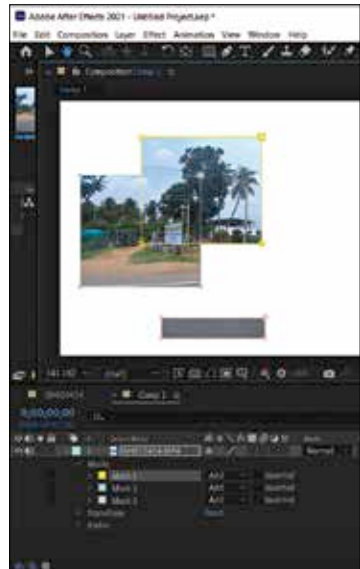
Masking used to add a particular part or cut some part out of a video and it does this by applying a mask, a virtual one! It changes how we see parts of a layer without actually altering the layer in question. It's giving a sneak peek into the video without actually revealing it in its entirety.

To create a mask, first select the layer in the timeline panel. Then click on the Shape builder tool and then make a shape in the preview panel and that's it. You have created a mask. You will see that only the part inside the shape has retained the video and everything outside has taken the colour of the composition. In this case, I have applied a square shape and thus we have a square window into the video.

The mask is now a property of the video and you can see it as a separate section in the layer's drop down menu. Every mask has its own properties just like any other element and you can change its features like path, feather, opacity and expansion.

To mask using the pen tool, first ensure that no layer is selected. Then, make your desired shape. This will exist in a new layer. Overlay the video over this layer in the way that you prefer. Now to transfer this as a mask over the video, click on the path and object path properties of the layer where the pen tools have been used and copy it. Then, select the video layer and pre-compose it. Click on the pre-composed video layer anywhere with the pen tool. Now in the position properties of the pre-comp, you need to paste these and you will see that a custom shaped mask has been applied to the video. You just need to blend it to make sure it doesn't look unprofessional.

You can also mask videos with vectors. To do this, just select and copy the vector from Adobe Illustrate, select the video in After Effects and paste the copied vector. This will create a mask or a number of masks under the video based on the number of parts of the object. **d**



A simple mask